Cleveland Business Mentors

CRM Design & Implementation: Client

Version 1.5 | In Progress | March 21, 2026

1. Overview

This document defines the complete CRM design and implementation specification for the CBM Client Entity within CRM. It covers all client data structures, field definitions, entity relationships, workflows and automation, and role-based security rules.

This document is intended for use by the CBM technology administrator during CRM configuration and by future technical staff onboarding to the platform.

Related documents: CBM-PRD-CRM.docx (platform requirements), CBM-PRD-CRM-Mentor.docx (mentor domain), CBM-PRD-CRM-Partner.docx (Partner domain), CBM-PRD-CRM-Sponsor.docx (Sponsor domain).

2. Data Structure

2.1 Data Model Overview

The client domain is built around four primary entities and two supporting entities. When a prospective client submits a Mentoring Request through the CBM website, the system automatically creates three linked records: an Company (the business), a Contact (the individual submitting the form), and an Engagement (the mentoring relationship, initially in Submitted status). All subsequent activity — sessions, NPS surveys, and workshop attendance — is linked to these anchor records.

The six entities in the client domain are:

- Company — the business being mentored
- Contact — individual person(s) associated with the business
- Engagement — the active mentoring relationship
- Session — individual meeting records between mentor and client
- NPS Survey Response — client satisfaction feedback records
- Workshop — structured events offered by CBM
- Workshop Attendance — records linking clients to workshops attended

2.2 Company Entity

The Company entity represents the business being mentored in addition to Companies that are Sponsors, or Partners. The four types of Companies are differentiated by the Company Role property. A single company can be multiple types.

Companies are the anchor record to which all Contacts, Engagements, and related activity are linked for the Mentoring process. All Company fields may be viewed and modified by the assigned mentor or any administrator directly within the CRM. The forms through which these fields are initially populated are defined in Section 4.1.

Field	Description / Values
Business Name	Full legal or operating name of the business. Optional. Text field. May be left blank for pre-startup applicants who have not yet named their business.
Website	Business website URL. Optional. URL field.
Address	Business mailing or physical address. Optional. Address field (street, city, state, zip).
Organization Type	Dropdown. Values: For-Profit | Non-Profit. Required.
Business Stage	Dropdown. Values: Pre-Startup | Startup | Early Stage | Growth Stage | Established. Required. Note: Revenue thresholds to differentiate Startup from Early Stage are a planned future enhancement.
NAICS Sector	Top-level industry classification. Dropdown of 20 NAICS sectors. Required.
NAICS Subsector	Second-level industry classification. Dropdown of ~100 NAICS subsectors, filtered by selected Sector. Both Sector and Subsector are stored as separate fields on the Company record. Required.
Mentoring Focus Areas	Multi-select dropdown. Values to be defined by CBM leadership. Required. Used for mentor matching and funder reporting.
Mentoring Needs Description	Free-form description of what the client is looking for in a mentoring engagement. Rich text. Required.
Company Role	Multi-select dropdown. Values to be defined by CBM leadership. Required. Used for differentiating between different types of companies.

The following fields capture additional business detail. They are typically empty for newly submitted clients and are completed at the mentor's discretion after assignment. All free-text fields support rich text formatting.

Field	Description / Values
Business Description	Detailed description of what the business does, its history, and founding story. Rich text. Optional.
Time in Operation	How long the business has been operating. Dropdown or date field. Optional.
Current Team Size	Number of current employees or team members. Number field. Optional.
Revenue Range	Approximate annual revenue range. Dropdown with ranges (TBD). Optional.
Funding Situation	Description of current funding sources or needs. Rich text. Optional.
Current Challenges	Description of the primary obstacles the business is facing. Rich text. Optional.

Field	Description / Values
Goals and Objectives	What the client wants to achieve through the mentoring engagement. Rich text. Optional.
Desired Outcomes (6-12 Months)	Specific outcomes the client hopes to achieve within the near term. Rich text. Optional.
Previous Mentoring/Advisory Experience	Whether the client has worked with a mentor or advisor before, and any relevant context. Rich text. Optional.
Current Professional Advisors	Multi-select checklist of advisor types currently engaged. Values: Banker / Financial Institution | Attorney / Legal Counsel | Accountant / CPA | IT Consultant | Insurance Agent | Marketing / PR Consultant | Business Coach. Optional.
Registered with State	Whether the business has filed with the state as an official legal entity. Yes/No. Optional.
State of Registration	State where the business is registered. Dropdown of US states. Shown when Registered with State = Yes. Optional.
Legal Business Structure	Dropdown. Values: Sole Proprietor | Partnership | LLC | S-Corp | C-Corp | Non-Profit 501(c)(3) | Other. Shown when Registered with State = Yes. Optional.
EIN on File	Whether the business has obtained an Employer Identification Number. Yes/No. Shown when Registered with State = Yes. Optional.
Date of Formation	Date the business entity was formally established. Date field. Shown when Registered with State = Yes. Optional.
Registered Agent	Whether the business has a designated registered agent. Yes/No. Shown when Registered with State = Yes. Optional.
EIN Number	The actual EIN number if deemed relevant by the mentor. Text field. Admin and assigned mentor access only. Not collected on the intake form — mentor-populated only. Restricted field.

2.2.3 Business Classification & Certifications

The following fields capture ownership designations and formal certifications held by the business. These are important for grant compliance reporting and program eligibility tracking. Certification-track fields use a four-value status scale: Ineligible, Eligible, Certified, or In Progress. All fields are optional.

Field	Description / Values
Veteran-Owned Business	Whether the business is majority-owned by one or more veterans. Dropdown. Values: Ineligible | Eligible | Certified | In Progress. Optional.
Service-Disabled Veteran-Owned (SDVOSB)	SBA/VA certification for businesses majority-owned by service-disabled veterans. Dropdown. Values: Ineligible | Eligible | Certified | In Progress. Optional.
Woman-Owned Small Business (WOSB)	SBA certification for businesses majority-owned and controlled by women. Dropdown. Values: Ineligible | Eligible | Certified | In Progress. Optional.
Minority-Owned Business Enterprise (MBE)	Certification for businesses majority-owned by racial or ethnic minorities, typically through NMSDC or a state/local certifying agency. Dropdown. Values: Ineligible | Eligible | Certified | In Progress. Optional.
Disadvantaged Business Enterprise (DBE)	Federal DOT certification for socially and economically disadvantaged business owners. Dropdown. Values: Ineligible | Eligible | Certified | In Progress. Optional.

Field	Description / Values
SBA Small Business	Whether the business meets SBA size standards and is registered as a small business in SAM.gov. Dropdown. Values: Ineligible | Eligible | Certified | In Progress. Optional.
HUBZone Certified	SBA certification for businesses located in and employing people from Historically Underutilized Business Zones. Dropdown. Values: Ineligible | Eligible | Certified | In Progress. Optional.
8(a) Program Participant	SBA 8(a) Business Development Program for socially and economically disadvantaged small business owners. Dropdown. Values: Ineligible | Eligible | Certified | In Progress. Optional.
LGBTQ+-Owned Business	Certification for businesses majority-owned by LGBTQ+ individuals, typically through the National LGBT Chamber of Commerce (NGLCC). Dropdown. Values: Ineligible | Eligible | Certified | In Progress. Optional.
Disability-Owned Business Enterprise (DOBE)	Certification for businesses majority-owned by people with disabilities, through Disability:IN. Dropdown. Values: Ineligible | Eligible | Certified | In Progress. Optional.
Native American / Tribal Owned	Business majority-owned by Native American, Alaska Native, or Native Hawaiian individuals or a tribal entity. Dropdown. Values: Ineligible | Eligible | Certified | In Progress. Optional.
Certified B Corporation	B Lab certification for businesses meeting verified social, environmental, and governance standards. Dropdown. Values: Ineligible | Eligible | Certified | In Progress. Optional.
Union Shop	Whether the business operates under a union agreement requiring employees to be union members. Yes/No. Optional.
Family-Owned Business	Whether the business is owned and operated by members of the same family. Yes/No. Optional.
Franchise	Whether this business operates as a franchise of a larger brand or system. Yes/No. Optional.
Social Enterprise	Whether the business has a primary social, environmental, or community mission alongside its commercial activity. Yes/No. Optional.
Other Certifications / Designations	Free-text field for any additional certifications, designations, or ownership classifications not covered above. Text field. Optional.

2.3 Contact Entity

The Contact entity represents an individual person associated with a business being mentored. Multiple contacts may be linked to a single Company. The person who submits the Phase 1 intake form automatically becomes the first Contact linked to the Company. Additional contacts can be added by an admin or mentor as the engagement progresses.

Field	Description / Values
First Name	Contact's first name. Required. Text field.
Last Name	Contact's last name. Required. Text field.
Email	Primary email address. Required. Email field.
Phone	Primary phone number. Optional. Phone field.
Role at Business	The contact's title or position within the business (e.g., Owner, Co-Founder, CEO, Manager). Optional. Text field.
Primary Contact	Identifies the main point of contact for the Company when multiple contacts are present. Yes/No checkbox. Defaults to Yes for the first contact created.

2.4 Engagement Entity

The Engagement entity defines the active mentoring relationship between CBM and a client business. It is linked to a Company and tracks the lifecycle, mentor assignments, and summary analytics for the relationship. Individual sessions, NPS responses, and workshop attendance are all linked to the Engagement.

Status Lifecycle

Engagements progress through the following statuses:

- Submitted — Mentoring Request received; pending admin review and mentor nomination.
- Pending Acceptance — Admin has nominated a mentor; system has notified the mentor and is awaiting their acceptance or refusal. A configurable acceptance window applies (default: 48 hours). If the mentor declines, the Engagement transitions to Mentor Declined and the admin is notified to nominate another mentor.
- Mentor Declined — The nominated mentor has declined the assignment. The admin uses the Mentor Declined view to identify these engagements and nominates a new mentor, starting the process over. No explanation is required from the declining mentor.
- Assigned — Mentor has accepted the assignment. The mentor is responsible for personally introducing themselves to the client. Phase 2 form deployment is at the mentor's discretion — it may be included in the introduction or deployed after the first session.
- Active — Mentoring is underway; sessions are being logged.
- On-Hold — A deliberate, temporary pause initiated by the client or mentor with intent to resume. May be set from Active or Dormant status.
- Dormant — No activity recorded and no future sessions scheduled beyond the cadence-aware threshold (see Section 4.5). System-triggered. Prompts admin follow-up. Reverts to Active when activity resumes.
- Inactive — Dormant for a configurable additional period (default: 60 days) with no response. System-triggered. Indicates the engagement is at serious risk of abandonment.
- Abandoned — Inactive for a configurable period (default: 90 days) with no response. System-triggered. Treated as permanently closed. All thresholds are admin-configurable system settings.
- Completed — The engagement was formally closed with goals achieved or by mutual agreement. Admin or mentor initiated.

Engagement Fields

Field	Description / Values
Company	Link to the Company (business) record. Required. Relationship field.
Status	Dropdown. Values: Submitted | Pending Acceptance | Mentor Declined | Assigned | Active | On-Hold | Dormant | Inactive | Abandoned | Completed. Required.
Start Date	Date the engagement officially became Active. Date field. System-populated on status change to Active.
Close Date	Date the engagement was closed (Completed or Abandoned). Date field. System-populated on status change to Completed or Abandoned.
Assigned Mentor	Link to the primary mentor Contact record. Required when status is Assigned or later.
Co-Mentor	Many-to-many relationship panel linking one or more Co-Mentor Contact records to the Engagement. Optional. Multiple Co-Mentors may be assigned simultaneously.
SME	Many-to-many relationship panel linking one or more SME Contact records to the Engagement. Optional. Multiple SMEs may be assigned simultaneously.
Engagement Close Reason	Dropdown. Values: Goals Achieved | Client Withdrew | Inactive / No Response | Other. Required when status is Completed or Abandoned.
Total Sessions	Count of all linked Session records. System-calculated (formula field). Read-only.
Total Sessions (Last 30 Days)	Count of Session records dated within the last 30 days. System-calculated (formula field). Read-only. Used for inactivity monitoring.
Last Session Date	Date/time of the most recent linked Session record. System-calculated (formula field). Read-only.
Total Session Hours	Sum of Duration (minutes) across all linked Session records, expressed in hours. System-calculated (formula field). Read-only.
Meeting Cadence	Expected frequency of mentor-client meetings. Dropdown. Values: Weekly | Bi-Weekly | Monthly | As Needed. Required. Set by admin or mentor at time of assignment. Used by inactivity monitoring to calculate cadence-aware Dormant thresholds: Weekly = 14 days, Bi-Weekly = 21 days, Monthly = 45 days, As Needed = 60 days.
Next Session Date/Time	Scheduled date and time of the next mentor-client meeting. Date/time field. Initially system-populated from the most recently logged Session's Next Session Date. Editable by the assigned mentor or admin at any time. When saved, automatically triggers a meeting request to all Engagement Contacts and assigned mentors (Primary Mentor, Co-Mentors, SMEs). Updating this field counts as a qualifying activity event that resets the inactivity monitoring clock. Optional.
Engagement Contacts	Many-to-many relationship panel listing the specific Contact records actively participating in this engagement. Set by the mentor at engagement setup and updated as needed. Determines who receives automated meeting requests and session summary emails. Optional — if empty, communications are sent to the Primary Contact on the linked Company record.

2.5 Session Entity

The Session entity records each individual meeting between a mentor and client. Sessions are linked to an Engagement and drive both the roll-up analytics on the Engagement record and the NPS survey trigger logic. Mentors are encouraged to complete the session form while on the call with the client so that Next Session Date can be set in real time. All note fields support rich text formatting.

Field	Description / Values
Engagement	Link to the parent Engagement record. Required. Relationship field.
Session Date/Time	Date and time the session occurred. Required. Date/time field.
Duration	Length of the session in minutes. Required. Number field.
Session Type	Dropdown. Values: In-Person | Video Call | Phone Call. Required.
Meeting Location Type	Dropdown. Values: CBM Office | Client's Place of Business | Other. Shown only when Session Type = In-Person. Required when In-Person.
Location Details	Free text description of the meeting location. Shown only when Meeting Location Type = Other. Optional. Text field.
Topics Covered	Multi-select dropdown of topic categories (values TBD) plus a free-text rich text field for additional detail. Optional.
Mentor Notes	Private notes from the mentor about the session content, observations, and context. Rich text. Access restricted to assigned mentor and admin. Optional.
Next Steps	Agreed-upon actions and follow-up items coming out of the session. Rich text. Optional.
New Business Started	Whether this session resulted in the start of a new business. Yes/No. Optional.
Next Session Date/Time	Scheduled date and time of the next meeting, set by the mentor while logging the current session. Date/time field. Optional. When saved, automatically populates the Next Session Date/Time field on the linked Engagement record. Intended to be set during the session while the mentor has the client on the call.
Logged By	Native EspoCRM Created By field, relabeled to “Logged By.” System-populated. Read-only. The CRM user who created the Session record. Visible on the Session detail view and used as a column on the Session list view to identify which mentor logged each session.
Mentor Attendees	Many-to-many relationship panel. Links the mentor Contact records who were physically present at this session. A session may have multiple mentor attendees; a mentor may be listed on multiple sessions. Required (save validation): at least one Contact from a Mentoring Company (Company Role = Mentoring Company) must be added to this panel before the Session record can be saved. The mentor who logs the session and the mentors listed as attendees are independent — the logger need not be an attendee and attendees need not be the logger.

2.6 NPS Survey Response Entity

The NPS Survey Response entity captures client satisfaction feedback at defined points in the engagement lifecycle. Surveys are triggered automatically by the system at three points: after the 2nd session, every 5 sessions thereafter, and at engagement close.

Field	Description / Values
Engagement	Link to the parent Engagement record. Required. Relationship field.
Session	Link to the Session record that triggered the survey, where applicable. Optional. Relationship field.
Survey Trigger	System-populated field indicating what triggered this survey. Dropdown. Values: 2nd Session | Every 5 Sessions | Engagement Close. Read-only.
Survey Date/Time	Date and time the survey response was submitted. System-populated. Read-only.
NPS Score	Standard NPS question: How likely are you to recommend CBM to a friend or colleague? Scale of 0-10. Required.
Did CBM Help You?	Yes/No. Required.
I Would Return to See This Mentor Again	Rating scale 1-5. Required.
Mentor Listened to My Needs	Rating scale 1-5. Required.
How Could CBM Better Meet Your Needs?	Open-ended feedback on how CBM could improve. Rich text. Optional.

2.7 Workshop Entity

The Workshop entity represents a structured event offered by CBM that clients may attend independently of their mentoring engagement. Workshops are tracked for both reporting purposes and to give mentors visibility into the learning activities of their assigned clients.

Field	Description / Values
Title	Name of the workshop. Required. Text field.
Date/Time	Scheduled date and time of the workshop. Required. Date/time field.
Topic/Category	Primary topic area of the workshop. Dropdown, aligned with Mentoring Focus Areas values (TBD). Required.
Presenter	Name or link to the presenter. Optional. Text or Contact relationship field.
Location	Where the workshop is held. Optional. Text or address field.
Description	Detailed description of the workshop content and objectives. Rich text. Optional.
Maximum Capacity	Maximum number of attendees. Optional. Number field.
Status	Dropdown. Values: Scheduled | Completed | Cancelled. Required.
Confirmed Attendees	System-calculated. Read-only. Integer field. Count of linked Workshop Attendance records where Attended = Yes. Displayed on the Workshop detail view and list view to show actual attendance at a glance.

2.8 Workshop Attendance Entity

The Workshop Attendance entity links a client Contact to a Workshop they registered for or attended. It allows mentors to see which workshops their clients have participated in and supports attendance reporting for CBM.

Field	Description / Values
Workshop	Link to the Workshop record. Required. Relationship field.
Contact	Link to the client Contact record. Required. Relationship field.
Engagement	Link to the active Engagement record for context. Required. Relationship field.
Attendance Date	Date of the workshop. Formula field that pulls dynamically from the linked Workshop's Date/Time field. Read-only. Always reflects the current Workshop date, even if the Workshop record is updated after the Attendance record is created.
Attended	Whether the client actually attended (as opposed to only registering). Yes/No. Required. Defaults to Yes.

2.9 Shared Platform Entities

The CBM CRM platform includes shared entities and communication capabilities available across all domains. All entities defined in this document — Company, Contact, Engagement, Session, NPS Survey Response, Workshop, and Workshop Attendance — must have relationship panels configured for each of the following as a standard part of their implementation.

- Notes and Comments — cross-record linked notes with one-level threaded discussion and internal-only visibility control.
- Documents — cross-record linked documents supporting both file uploads and external URL references (e.g., Google Drive links), with internal-only visibility control.
- Email and Calls — The CRM native activity panels for communication tracking. Emails sync automatically via Gmail OAuth; calls are logged manually by mentors and must be linked to both the Contact and active Engagement at time of logging.

Full entity definitions, field specifications, and implementation requirements for Notes, Comments, and Documents are documented in CBM-PRD-CRM.docx, Section 18: Shared Platform Entities. Email and call handling requirements are documented in CBM-PRD-CRM.docx, Section 10: Communication Requirements.

3. Relationships

This section defines the entity relationships in the client domain — how records connect to each other, how those relationships are created, and what data is visible from each side. All relationships described here are configured in The CRM's Entity Manager.

3.1 Company → Contact

Relationship type: One-to-Many. One Company may have many Contacts; each Contact belongs to one Company.

- The first Contact is created automatically when a Mentoring Request form is submitted. The submitting individual becomes the primary Contact linked to the new Company.
- Additional Contacts may be added to the Company at any time by an admin or the assigned mentor as additional individuals from the business become involved in the engagement.
- The Primary Contact flag on the Contact record identifies the main point of contact when multiple Contacts exist on a Company.
- From the Company record, all linked Contacts are visible in a Contact relationship panel.
- From each Contact record, the linked Company is visible as a lookup field.

3.2 Company → Engagement

Relationship type: One-to-Many. One Company may have many Engagements over time; each Engagement belongs to one Company.

- The first Engagement is created automatically when a Mentoring Request form is submitted, with status set to Submitted.
- A Company may have more than one Engagement over its lifetime — for example, a client who completes one engagement and returns for a new one later. Each is tracked as a separate Engagement record.
- Only one Engagement per Company should be in an active status (Submitted, Assigned, Active, or On-Hold) at any given time.
- From the Company record, all linked Engagements are visible in an Engagement relationship panel, showing current and historical engagements.
- From each Engagement record, the linked Company is visible as a lookup field.

3.3 Engagement → Mentor / Co-Mentor / SME

Relationship type: Many-to-Many for Co-Mentor and SME roles. Each Engagement has one Assigned Mentor, but may have multiple Co-Mentors and multiple SMEs. All are linked to Contact records in the mentor pool.

- The Assigned Mentor link is set by an admin when the Engagement moves from Submitted to Assigned status.
- The Co-Mentor and SME links are optional and may be set at any time during an active engagement.
- The Assigned Mentor is stored as a single lookup field on the Engagement record. Co-Mentor and SME assignments are stored as many-to-many relationship panels, allowing multiple Co-Mentors and multiple SMEs to be linked to a single Engagement. This supports role-specific access control and capacity management for each assigned individual.
- From a mentor's Contact record, all Engagements where they are assigned as Mentor, Co-Mentor, or SME are visible via relationship panels on the mentor profile.

3.4 Engagement → Session

Relationship type: One-to-Many. One Engagement may have many Sessions; each Session belongs to one Engagement.

- Session records are created manually by the assigned mentor after each meeting.
- Sessions drive the roll-up analytics fields on the Engagement record — Total Sessions, Total Sessions (Last 30 Days), Last Session Date, and Total Session Hours are all calculated from linked Session records.
- Sessions also drive NPS survey trigger logic — the system monitors session count per Engagement to determine when to send surveys.
- From the Engagement record, all linked Sessions are visible in a Session relationship panel sorted by date descending.
- From each Session record, the linked Engagement (and through it, the Company) is visible as a lookup field.

3.5 Engagement → NPS Survey Response

Relationship type: One-to-Many. One Engagement may have many NPS Survey Responses over its lifetime; each NPS Survey Response belongs to one Engagement.

- NPS Survey Response records are created automatically by the system when a survey trigger fires (after 2nd session, every 5 sessions thereafter, at engagement close).
- Each NPS Survey Response is linked to both the Engagement and, where applicable, the Session that triggered it.
- From the Engagement record, all linked NPS Survey Responses are visible in a relationship panel, allowing mentors and admins to track satisfaction trends over the course of the engagement.

3.6 Contact → Workshop Attendance

Relationship type: One-to-Many. One Contact may have many Workshop Attendance records; each Workshop Attendance record belongs to one Contact.

- Workshop Attendance records are created when a client registers for or attends a workshop.
- Each Workshop Attendance record links a Contact to a Workshop and to the active Engagement, providing full traceability of workshop participation within the context of the mentoring relationship.
- From the Contact record, all workshop attendance history is visible in a Workshop Attendance relationship panel.
- From the Engagement record, workshop attendance related to that engagement is also visible, giving mentors a complete picture of their client's learning activities.

3.7 Workshop Attendance → Workshop

Relationship type: Many-to-One. Many Workshop Attendance records may link to one Workshop; each Workshop Attendance record belongs to one Workshop.

- The Workshop Attendance entity is the linking record between a client Contact and a Workshop. It is not a direct relationship between Contact and Workshop.
- From the Workshop record, all linked Workshop Attendance records are visible, providing a full attendee list for each event.
- Workshop attendance data feeds into both mentor visibility (mentors can see which workshops their clients attended) and CBM reporting (aggregate attendance counts by workshop, topic, and client segment).

3.8 Engagement → Engagement Contacts

Relationship type: Many-to-Many. An Engagement may have many participating Contacts; a Contact may participate in multiple Engagements.

- The Engagement Contacts panel lists the specific individuals from the client business who are actively participating in the engagement. It is set by the mentor at the time the engagement is assigned and updated as needed.
- Engagement Contacts determine who receives automated meeting requests when Next Session Date/Time is saved on the Engagement, and who receives session summary emails drafted by the mentor.
- If the Engagement Contacts panel is empty, automated communications default to the Primary Contact on the linked Company record.

3.9 Shared Platform Entity Relationships

The following shared platform entities — Note, Comment, and Document — maintain many-to-many relationships with all client domain entities. These relationships allow a single Note or Document to be linked to multiple records simultaneously across entity types.

- Note → Company, Contact, Engagement, Session, NPS Survey Response, Workshop, Workshop Attendance: Many-to-many. A Note may be linked to any combination of these records simultaneously.
- Comment → Note: Many-to-One. Comments are always children of a single parent Note.
- Document → Company, Contact, Engagement, Session, NPS Survey Response, Workshop, Workshop Attendance: Many-to-many. A Document may be linked to any combination of these records simultaneously.
- Email and Calls → Contact and Engagement: CRM native activity records linked to both the Contact and the active Engagement. See Section 2.9 and CBM-PRD-CRM.docx Section 18.5 for configuration requirements.

4. Processes & Workflows

This section defines the step-by-step processes and automated workflows that govern the client lifecycle within CRM. Automated steps are executed by CRM's workflow engine unless otherwise noted.

4.1 Client Intake

The intake process begins when a prospective client submits the Phase 1 Mentoring Request form on the CBM website. The form is built in WordPress and posts data to CRM via the REST API.

1. Client completes and submits the Phase 1 Mentoring Request form on the CBM website.
2. CRM REST API receives the form submission and automatically creates three linked records: Company (the business), Contact (the submitting individual, flagged as Primary Contact), and Engagement (status: Submitted).
3. Admin reviews new submissions by selecting the "New Client Submissions" global search preset on the Engagement entity, which displays all Engagement records with a status of Submitted.
4. Admin reviews the submission for completeness and basic eligibility. Admin determines whether the request is suitable for the program.
5. If eligible, admin proceeds to mentor nomination (see Section 4.2). If not eligible, admin updates the Engagement status to Abandoned with Close Reason: Other, and notifies the applicant via email.

Note: The detailed screening and eligibility criteria for Step 4 are to be defined by CBM leadership. This PRD assumes a basic review process only. A more structured qualification workflow may be added in a future revision.

Future enhancement: Automated or AI-assisted mentor matching is a planned future capability. The data model — NAICS sector/subsector and Mentoring Focus Areas on the Company; skills and expertise tags on the mentor Contact — is designed from day one to support this. No restructuring will be required when this feature is implemented.

4.1.1 Phase 1 Mentoring Request Form Fields

The following fields are collected on the public Mentoring Request form on the CBM website. The form is built in WordPress and posts data to the CRM via the REST API, which automatically creates the Company, Contact, and Engagement records. The Populates column identifies which CRM entity each field is stored on.

Field	Populates	Description / Notes
First Name	Contact	Required. Text field.
Last Name	Contact	Required. Text field.
Email Address	Contact	Required. Email field. Primary email used for all follow-up communications.
Phone	Contact	Required. Phone field.
Zip Code	Contact	Required. Text field. Used for geographic reporting.
Business Name	Company	Optional. Text field. May be left blank for pre-startup applicants.
Website	Company	Optional. URL field.
Address	Company	Optional. Address field (street, city, state, zip).
Organization Type	Company	Required. Dropdown. Values: For-Profit | Non-Profit.
Business Stage	Company	Required. Dropdown. Values: Pre-Startup | Startup | Early Stage | Growth Stage | Established.
NAICS Sector	Company	Required. Dropdown of 20 NAICS sectors.
NAICS Subsector	Company	Required. Dropdown of ~100 NAICS subsectors, filtered by selected Sector. Stored as a separate field from NAICS Sector.
Mentoring Focus Areas	Company	Required. Multi-select dropdown. Values to be defined by CBM leadership. Used for mentor matching and funder reporting.
Mentoring Needs Description	Company	Required. Rich text. Free-form description of what the client is seeking from the mentoring engagement.

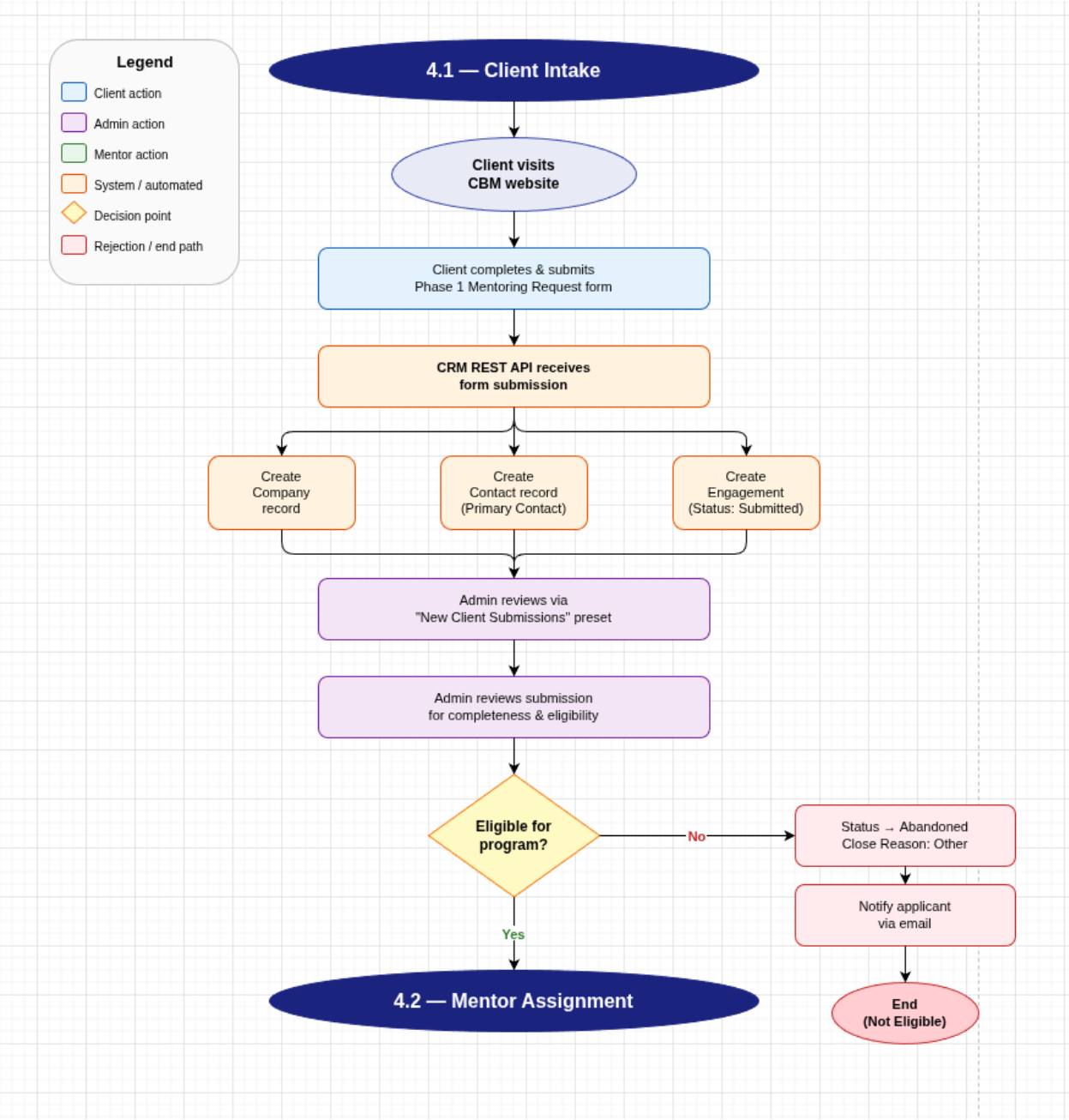
4.1.2 Phase 2 Client Registration Form Fields

The following fields are collected via a second form deployed by the mentor at their discretion after assignment. The mentor may send the Phase 2 form link in their initial introduction to the client or after the first session. All fields are optional. All free-text fields support rich text formatting. The EIN Number field is not collected on this form — it is entered directly in the CRM by the mentor if needed.

Field	Populates	Description / Notes
Business Description	Company	Rich text. Detailed description of what the business does, its history, and founding story.
Time in Operation	Company	Dropdown or date field. How long the business has been operating.
Current Team Size	Company	Number field. Number of current employees or team members.
Revenue Range	Company	Dropdown with ranges (TBD). Approximate annual revenue range.
Funding Situation	Company	Rich text. Description of current funding sources or needs.
Current Challenges	Company	Rich text. Primary obstacles the business is currently facing.
Goals and Objectives	Company	Rich text. What the client wants to achieve through the mentoring engagement.

Field	Populates	Description / Notes
Desired Outcomes (6-12 Months)	Company	Rich text. Specific outcomes the client hopes to achieve in the near term.
Previous Mentoring / Advisory Experience	Company	Rich text. Whether the client has worked with a mentor or advisor before, and any relevant context.
Current Professional Advisors	Company	Multi-select checklist. Values: Banker / Financial Institution | Attorney / Legal Counsel | Accountant / CPA | IT Consultant | Insurance Agent | Marketing / PR Consultant | Business Coach.
Registered with State	Company	Yes/No. Whether the business has filed with the state as an official legal entity.
State of Registration	Company	Dropdown of US states. Shown when Registered with State = Yes.
Legal Business Structure	Company	Dropdown. Values: Sole Proprietor | Partnership | LLC | S-Corp | C-Corp | Non-Profit 501(c)(3) | Other. Shown when Registered with State = Yes.
EIN on File	Company	Yes/No. Whether the business has obtained an Employer Identification Number. Shown when Registered with State = Yes.
Date of Formation	Company	Date field. Date the business entity was formally established. Shown when Registered with State = Yes.
Registered Agent	Company	Yes/No. Whether the business has a designated registered agent. Shown when Registered with State = Yes.

4.1.3 Client Intake Process Diagram

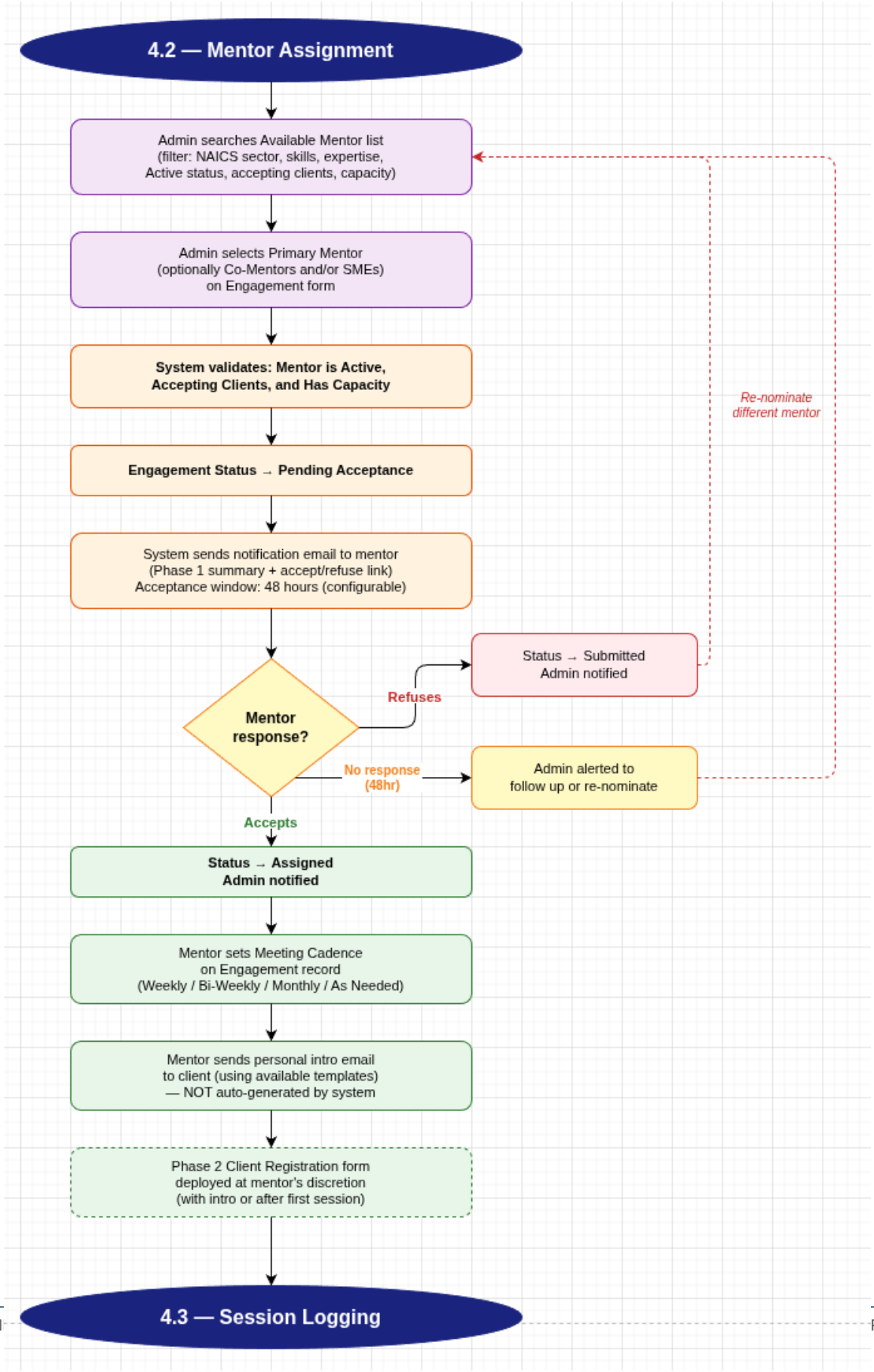


4.2 Mentor Assignment

The mentor assignment process begins after the admin has reviewed and accepted a client intake submission.

1. Admin searches the Available Mentor list under the Mentors/Contacts Entity and can filter by NAICS sector/subsector, Mentoring Focus Areas, skills/expertise tags, Active status, accepting clients = Yes, and available capacity.
2. Admin selects a primary mentor (and optionally one or more co-mentors and/or SMEs) on the Engagement form. The System only allows the Admin to select a Mentor that is Active, accepting clients, and has capacity before allowing nomination.
3. The Engagement status is changes to Pending Acceptance.
4. System sends an automatic notification email to the nominated mentor with a summary of the client's Phase 1 intake data and a link to accept or refuse the assignment. A configurable acceptance window applies (default: 48 hours).
5. If the mentor accepts: Engagement status changes to Assigned. Admin is notified. Proceed to Step 6.
6. If the mentor declines: Engagement status is set to Mentor Declined. The admin determines the mentor declined using the Mentor Declined view and nominates a new mentor, starting the process over. No explanation is required from the declining mentor.
7. If no response within the acceptance window: Admin is alerted to follow up or nominate a different mentor. Engagement remains in Pending Acceptance.
8. Assigned Mentor accesses the Engagement record and sets the Meeting Cadence field on the Engagement record.
9. Mentor personally introduces themselves to the client via an email generated from the Engagement record. Email templates are available to mentors as a starting point for personalized introductions. The introduction is sent by the mentor — not auto-generated by the system to maintain a more personable relationship.
10. The collection of more detailed client information via the Phase 2 Client Registration form is at the mentor's discretion. The mentor may include the Phase 2 form link in the introduction email or deploy it after the first session to give the mentor time to explain it in person.
11. Once the first session is logged, the Engagement status changes to Active.

4.2.1 Mentor Assignment Process Diagram

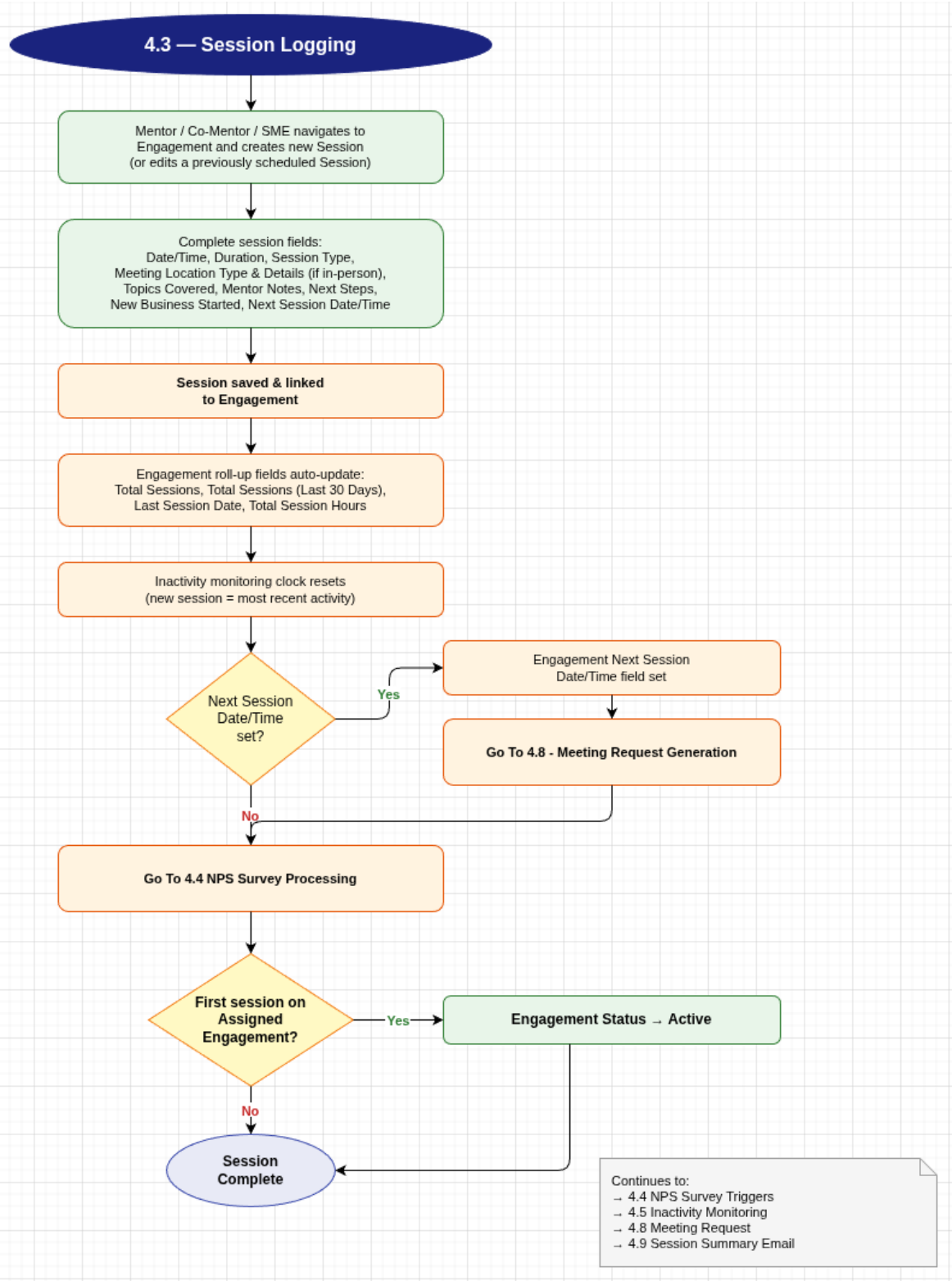


4.3 Session Logging

Sessions are logged by the assigned mentor, co-mentor, or SME after each meeting with the client. There is no admin review or approval of session records.

1. Mentor, co-mentor, or SME navigates to the Engagement record in CRM and creates a new Session record, or edits a previously scheduled Session Record.
2. Session fields completed: Date/Time, Duration, Session Type, Meeting Location Type and Details (if in-person), Topics Covered, Mentor Notes, Next Steps, New Business Started flag, and Next Session Date/Time. Mentors are encouraged to set the Next Session Date/Time while on the call with the client.
3. Session record is saved and linked to the Engagement.
4. Engagement roll-up fields update automatically: Total Sessions, Total Sessions (Last 30 Days), Last Session Date, and Total Session Hours are recalculated.
5. Inactivity monitoring clock resets — the new session date is recognized as the most recent activity event.
6. If Next Session Date/Time was set on the Session form, the Engagement's Next Session Date/Time field is automatically updated and a meeting request is sent to all Engagement Contacts and assigned mentors (Primary Mentor, Co-Mentors, SMEs). See Section 4.8 for meeting request workflow details.
7. System checks session count against NPS survey trigger thresholds (see Section 4.4).
8. If this is the first session logged on an Assigned Engagement, Engagement status automatically changes to Active.

4.3.1 Session Logging Process Diagram



4.4 NPS Survey Triggers

NPS surveys are delivered via LimeSurvey and triggered automatically by the CRM's workflow engine based on session count per Engagement. Survey responses are posted back to the CRM via the LimeSurvey API and stored as NPS Survey Response records linked to the Engagement.

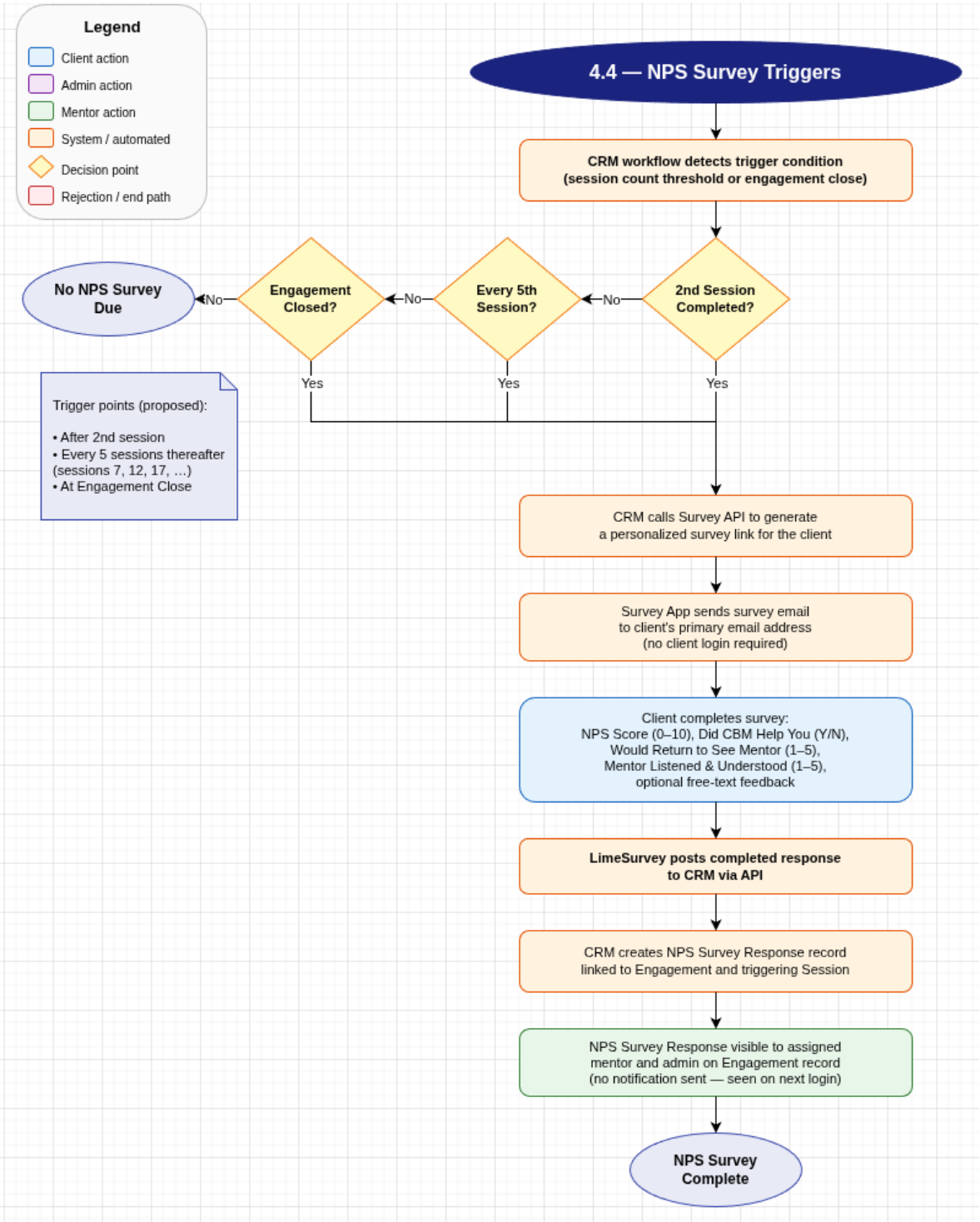
Trigger points(Proposed):

- After the 2nd session — first NPS survey triggered. Sufficient sessions to form a meaningful impression of the mentoring relationship.
- Every 5 sessions thereafter — recurring pulse check (sessions 7, 12, 17, etc.).
- At Engagement Close — final NPS survey triggered regardless of session count.

Survey delivery and response flow:

1. CRM workflow detects trigger condition (session count threshold or engagement close).
2. CRM calls LimeSurvey API to generate a personalized survey link for the client.
3. LimeSurvey sends the survey email to the client's primary email address. No client login is required.
4. Client completes the survey: NPS Score (0-10), Did CBM Help You (Yes/No), I Would Return to See This Mentor Again (1-5), Mentor Listened to My Needs (1-5), and optional free-text feedback.
5. LimeSurvey posts completed response to CRM via API.
6. CRM creates an NPS Survey Response record linked to the Engagement and, where applicable, the triggering Session record.
7. NPS Survey Response is visible to the assigned mentor and admin on the Engagement record. No notification is sent to the mentor — they will see the response on next login.

4.4.1 NPS Survey Triggers Process Diagram



4.5 Inactivity Monitoring

Inactivity monitoring tracks engagement activity and automatically transitions Engagement status when activity falls below expected thresholds. All thresholds are admin-configurable system settings. The monitoring clock resets on any qualifying activity event.

Qualifying activity events that reset the inactivity clock:

- A Session record logged against the Engagement.
- An email sent or received linked to the Engagement.
- A call logged against the Engagement.
- A future Session scheduled in CRM or Cal.com linked to the Engagement. Scheduled future sessions prevent inactivity transitions even if no recent activity has occurred.

Cadence-aware Dormant thresholds (admin-configurable, defaults shown):

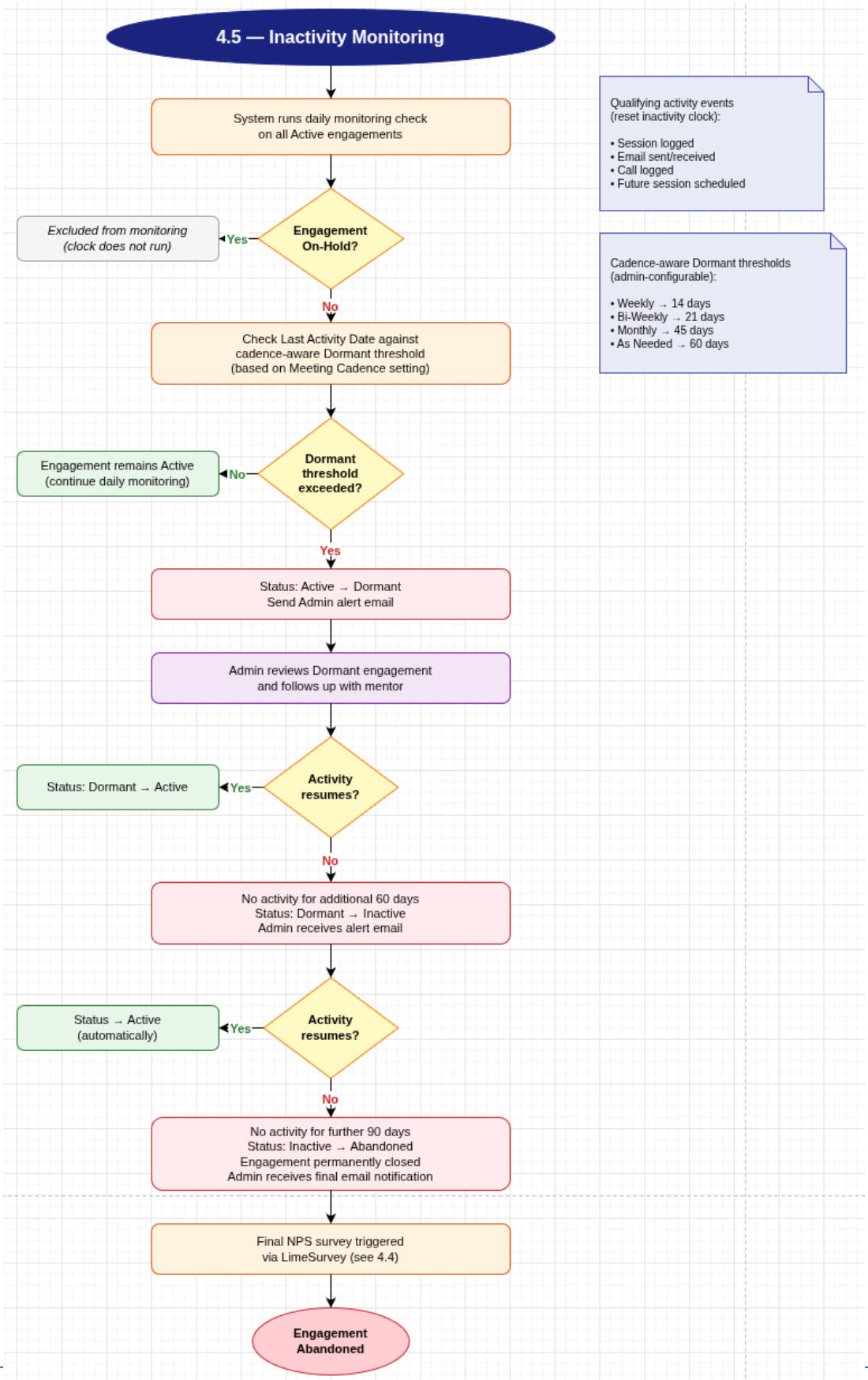
- Weekly cadence — Dormant after 14 days of no qualifying activity.
- Bi-Weekly cadence — Dormant after 21 days of no qualifying activity.
- Monthly cadence — Dormant after 45 days of no qualifying activity.
- As Needed cadence — Dormant after 60 days of no qualifying activity.

Status transition flow:

1. System monitors qualifying activity events daily against the cadence-aware threshold.
2. When threshold is exceeded: Engagement status changes from Active to Dormant. Admin receives an alert notification.
3. Admin reviews the Dormant engagement and follows up with the mentor as appropriate.
4. If activity resumes: Engagement status reverts to Active automatically.
5. If no activity for an additional 60 days after becoming Dormant: Engagement status changes to Inactive. Admin receives an alert notification.
6. If no activity for a further 90 days after becoming Inactive: Engagement status changes to Abandoned. Engagement is treated as permanently closed. Admin receives a final notification.

Note: On-Hold engagements are excluded from inactivity monitoring. The clock does not run while an Engagement is in On-Hold status.

4.5.1 Inactivity Monitoring Process Diagram



4.6 Engagement Close

An engagement may be formally closed by an admin or mentor (Completed status) or automatically by the system (Abandoned status). In either case, a final NPS survey is triggered and the Engagement record is preserved for historical reporting.

Mentor or admin-initiated close (Completed):

1. Admin or mentor navigates to the Engagement record and changes status to Completed.
2. Close Reason is recorded: Goals Achieved | Client Withdrew | Other.
3. Close Date is system-populated with the current date.
4. Final NPS survey is triggered automatically via LimeSurvey (see Section 4.4).
5. Engagement record becomes read-only for core fields. Notes, Comments, and Documents may still be added post-close by the mentor or admin.

System-initiated close (Abandoned):

1. System automatically changes Engagement status to Abandoned after the configured Inactive threshold is exceeded (default: 90 days).
2. Close Reason is set automatically to: Inactive / No Response.
3. Close Date is system-populated.
4. Final NPS survey is triggered automatically via LimeSurvey.
5. Admin receives a notification that the Engagement has been Abandoned.
6. Engagement record becomes read-only for core fields. Notes, Comments, and Documents may still be added post-close by the mentor or admin.

4.7 Client Offboarding / Record Retention

CBM retains all client records indefinitely. There is no scheduled deletion or archival process. This policy reflects both the possibility of clients returning for future engagements and the need to support historical funder reporting.

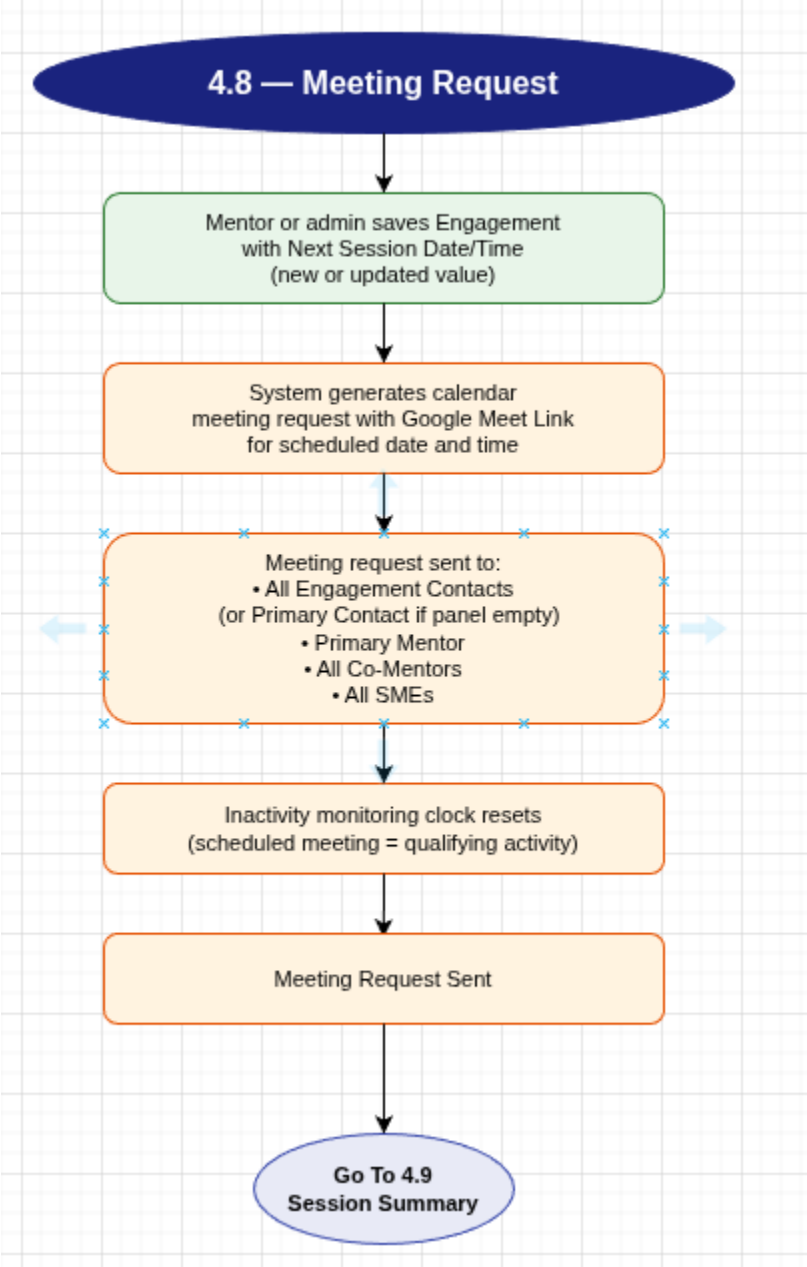
- Company and Contact records are retained permanently and are never deleted, regardless of Engagement status.
- Closed Engagements (Completed or Abandoned) are retained permanently as historical records and are never deleted or archived.
- Closed Engagements are never reopened. If a former client returns for mentoring, a new Engagement record is created and linked to their existing Company and Contact records. Historical engagements remain intact.
- No data purging or anonymization process is required at this time. If CBM becomes subject to data retention or privacy regulations in the future, this policy must be revisited.

4.8 Meeting Request

A meeting request is sent automatically whenever the Next Session Date/Time field is saved on the Engagement record — whether set via the Session form or edited directly by the mentor or admin on the Engagement.

1. Mentor or admin saves the Engagement record with a Next Session Date/Time value (new or updated).
2. System generates a calendar meeting request for the scheduled date and time.
3. Meeting request is sent to: all Contacts in the Engagement Contacts panel (or the Primary Contact if the panel is empty), the assigned Primary Mentor, all Co-Mentors, and all SMEs assigned to the Engagement.
4. Saving a new Next Session Date/Time resets the inactivity monitoring clock, treating the scheduled meeting as a qualifying activity event.

4.8.1 Meeting Request Process Diagram

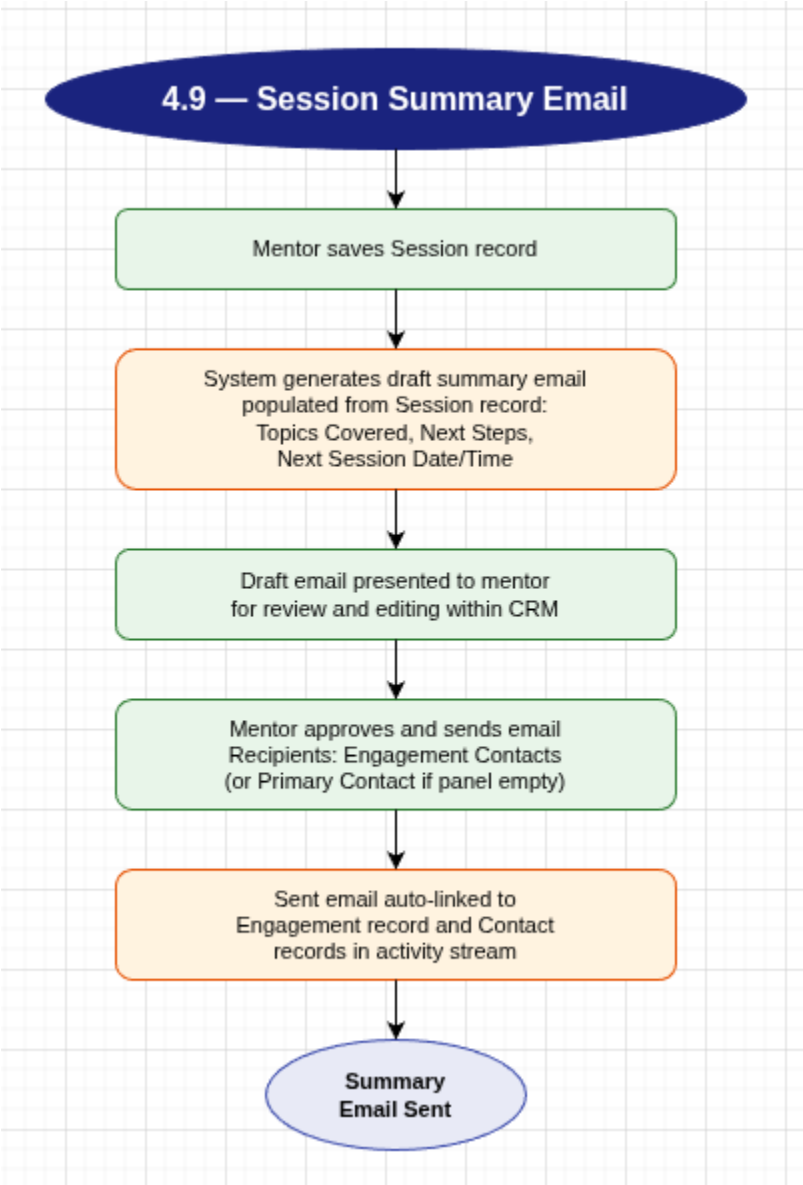


4.9 Session Summary Email

After logging a session, the mentor may send a summary email to the client recapping what was discussed and confirming next steps. The system drafts the email automatically from session data; the mentor reviews and approves before it is sent.

1. Mentor saves the Session record.
2. System generates a draft summary email populated from: Topics Covered, Next Steps, and Next Session Date/Time from the Session record.
3. Draft email is presented to the mentor for review and editing within CRM before sending.
4. Mentor approves and sends the email. Recipients are the Engagement Contacts panel (or Primary Contact if empty).
5. Sent email is automatically linked to the Engagement record and the relevant Contact records in the activity stream.

4.9.1 Session Summary Email Process Diagram



5. Security

This section defines the role-based access control rules, field-level security restrictions, and data visibility rules that govern who can see and interact with client records in CRM. All rules are implemented through CRM's native Roles and Teams configuration. Clients themselves have no CRM access — all client-facing interactions are conducted via email.

5.1 Role-Based Access Control

The following table defines Create, Read, Update, and Delete permissions for each role across all client domain entities. "Own" means the role can perform the action only on records they are directly assigned to. "All" means the role can perform the action across all records of that type.

Company and Contact:

Role	Create	Read	Update	Delete	Notes
Admin	All	All	All	All	Full access.
Primary Mentor	No	Own	Own	No	Read and update own assigned clients only.
Co-Mentor	No	Own	Own	No	Scoped to engagements where assigned as Co-Mentor.
SME	No	Own	No	No	Read only. Scoped to engagements where assigned as SME.
Board Member	No	No	No	No	No access to individual client records.

Engagement:

Role	Create	Read	Update	Delete	Notes
Admin	All	All	All	All	Full access including status changes.
Primary Mentor	No	Own	Own	No	Can update fields and log activity on own engagements. Cannot change status to Completed or Abandoned — admin only.
Co-Mentor	No	Own	Own	No	Scoped to assigned engagements. Same update rights as Primary Mentor.
SME	No	Own	No	No	Read only on assigned engagements.
Board Member	No	No	No	No	No access to individual engagement records.

Session:

Role	Create	Read	Update	Delete	Notes
Admin	All	All	All	All	Full access.

Role	Create	Read	Update	Delete	Notes
Primary Mentor	Own	Own	Own	No	Can create and edit sessions on own engagements.
Co-Mentor	Own	Own	Own	No	Can create and edit sessions on assigned engagements.
SME	Own	Own	Own	No	Can create and edit sessions on assigned engagements.
Board Member	No	No	No	No	No access.

NPS Survey Response:

Role	Create	Read	Update	Delete	Notes
Admin	All	All	All	All	Full access.
Primary Mentor	No	Own	No	No	Read only on own assigned engagements.
Co-Mentor	No	Own	No	No	Read only on assigned engagements.
SME	No	Own	No	No	Read only on assigned engagements.
Board Member	No	No	No	No	No access to individual NPS records.

Notes, Comments, and Documents:

Role	Create	Read	Update	Delete	Notes
Admin	All	All	All	All	Full access. Only role that can see Internal Only records.
Primary Mentor	Own	Own	Own	No	Can create notes and documents on own engagement records. Cannot see Internal Only records.
Co-Mentor	Own	Own	Own	No	Same as Primary Mentor, scoped to assigned engagements.
SME	Own	Own	Own	No	Same as Primary Mentor, scoped to assigned engagements.
Board Member	No	No	No	No	No access.

Workshop and Workshop Attendance:

Role	Create	Read	Update	Delete	Notes
Admin	All	All	All	All	Full access including creating workshops.
Primary Mentor	Own	All	No	No	Read only on Workshop records. Can create and update Workshop Attendance records for own assigned clients.
Co-Mentor	Own	All	No	No	Read only on Workshop records. Can create and update Workshop Attendance records for own assigned clients.
SME	No	All	No	No	Read only.

Role	Create	Read	Update	Delete	Notes
Board Member	No	No	No	No	No access to individual records.

5.2 Field-Level Security

The following fields have access restrictions that are more granular than the general role-based permissions defined in Section 5.1. These restrictions are implemented through CRM's field-level access control configuration.

Field	Restricted To	Rationale
EIN Number (Account)	Admin and assigned Primary Mentor only	Contains sensitive government-issued tax identification. Not relevant to Co-Mentor or SME roles. Mentor-populated only — not collected on intake form.
Internal Only Notes	Admin only	Notes flagged as Internal Only are hidden from all mentor roles regardless of engagement assignment. Used for admin-level observations and escalation records.
Internal Only Documents	Admin only	Documents flagged as Internal Only follow the same restriction as Internal Only Notes.

All other fields across Company, Contact, Engagement, Session, NPS Survey Response, Workshop, and Workshop Attendance entities are accessible to all roles with engagement access, subject to the Create/Read/Update/Delete permissions defined in Section 5.1.

5.3 Data Visibility Rules

Data visibility rules govern which records each role can see within CRM, independent of field-level permissions. These rules are implemented through CRM's Teams and Owner-based access model.

- Admin — Full visibility across all records of all entity types. No restrictions.
- Primary Mentor — Sees only Companies, Contacts, Engagements, Sessions, NPS Survey Responses, Notes, Documents, and Workshop Attendance records where they are the assigned Primary Mentor on the linked Engagement.
- Co-Mentor — Sees only records associated with Engagements where they are assigned as Co-Mentor. Visibility is scoped to the specific Engagement — not to the Company or Contact as a whole.
- SME — Sees only records associated with Engagements where they are assigned as SME. Same scoping as Co-Mentor.
- Board Member — No visibility into individual client records of any type. Access is limited to aggregate reporting dashboards and summary metrics only.

- Dual-role mentors — A mentor serving as Primary Mentor on one engagement and Co-Mentor or SME on another sees all records where they are assigned in any capacity. CRM's role-based filtering handles this naturally without custom configuration.
- Clients — No CRM access of any kind. All client-facing communication is conducted via email. Clients never log into CRM.

6. Implementation Steps

Implementation steps for the client domain are documented in CBM-PRD-CRM-Implementation.docx. That document is the single authoritative implementation reference — steps in CBM-PRD-CRM-Implementation.docx supersede any implementation steps previously contained in this document.

7. Document Control

Field	Value
Version	1.6
Status	In Progress — Added Process Diagrams
Last Updated	March 21, 2026
Next Review	After review of Relationships, Workflows, and Security sections
Related Documents	CBM-PRD-CRM.docx, CBM-PRD-CRM-Mentor.docx